



Guard them with your life.

the coil it's attached to move over the magnet. This movement creates voltage, which is picked up as sound. As you move away from the microphone, how strongly the diaphragm vibrates reduces. So the further you step back, the more you fade away. Omnidirectional mics pick up sound from all directions and their field of capture is a sphere that expands outwards around the diaphragm. A directional microphone or a cardioid microphone captures sound from one direction and ignores all the others.

Both have their own advantages and disadvantages. An omnidirectional mic is brilliant because it gives you a flat tonal representation while a cardioid 'colours' the sound. But a cardioid mic is useless if the source of the sound is off center. It makes most sense to get a mic that can be both and yes, they do exist.

You can also pick up several other components like pre-amps, mic stands, compressors, vu meters and a whole bunch of things too. But they're not as important.

(Wo)men at work

Now that your studio is up and running, let's start recording from start to finish. Three are the number of steps here. The first being recording, the second being mixing and the final being mastering.

While recording may seem like it's no big deal, it's important to capture the sound right when you're in the studio. When you're recording voice overs, or songs, every time the letter 'P' is pronounced or the 'puh' sound is made, air is pushed out of our mouths and it hits the mic. This ruins everything and it would make a lot of sense in throwing on a spit guard/pop filter.

The second step to recording is getting your levels right. The levels are how loud your recording is. If it's too low, you might miss details and if it's too high, the mic won't be able to cope. Levels are measured in decibels and it's best to keep them at -12dB so that you can bump them later.